

# DOCUMENT 10

## NO-RESPONSE FOLLOW-UP & CONTACT RESEARCH PROTOCOL

How Student Fellows Find the Right Person, Phone Number, Department & Next Route After an Email Gets No Reply

### CORE RULE

No response does not automatically mean “not interested.” It may mean the wrong inbox, wrong person, bad timing, a crowded inbox, or an organization with a different process. The fellow's job is to professionally find the next legitimate route — without becoming repetitive or intrusive.

## 1. The No-Response Escalation Path

| Stage  | Action                         | What the Fellow Does                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| STEP 1 | Original email                 | Record recipient, date, subject, attachment(s) and ask.                                                                                                                 |
| STEP 2 | First follow-up                | After approximately 3–5 business days, send one concise follow-up in the same thread.                                                                                   |
| STEP 3 | Research the organization      | Use the official website and public web search to identify the right department and current public business phone number.                                               |
| STEP 4 | Research the right person      | Use LinkedIn and other public professional sources to identify the current person/role responsible for community impact, partnerships, foundation, CSR, marketing, etc. |
| STEP 5 | Call the main business number  | Ask to be routed to the appropriate department/person. A name, title, extension or departmental email is a successful result.                                           |
| STEP 6 | Second targeted outreach       | Send a newly personalized message to the verified person or department; reference the prior outreach only when useful.                                                  |
| STEP 7 | LinkedIn professional outreach | Use a short professional connection/message if appropriate. Do not repeatedly message.                                                                                  |
| STEP 8 | Final follow-up / nurture      | If no response after the approved sequence, mark the lead for later follow-up rather than continuing to chase.                                                          |

## 2. What to Search for Online

Start with the organization's official website whenever possible. Search for pages such as Community Impact, Corporate Responsibility, Foundation, Giving, Sponsorships, Partnerships, Community Affairs, Social Impact, Education, Youth Programs, Local Market Leadership, Media/Press or Contact Us.

|                                                           |                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| • [Company] community affairs                             | • [Company] community impact New York             |
| • [Company] corporate responsibility                      | • [Company] foundation contact                    |
| • [Company] community partnerships director               | • [Company] social impact New York                |
| • [Company] sponsorship contact                           | • [Company] charitable giving                     |
| • [Company] community relations phone                     | • site:linkedin.com/in [Company] community impact |
| • site:linkedin.com/in [Company] corporate responsibility |                                                   |

## 3. Using LinkedIn Correctly

LinkedIn is primarily a professional verification and routing tool. Search the company and likely job functions. Confirm the person currently works there and that the role matches the outreach. Useful titles may include Director/VP of Community Impact, Corporate Social Responsibility, Corporate Citizenship, Community Affairs, Foundation, Social Impact, Partnerships, External Affairs, Public Affairs, Local Market Leadership, Marketing, Education Programs or Community Engagement.

**Do not:** assume an old LinkedIn profile is current; scrape or hunt for private contact information; message multiple unrelated employees at the same company at once; or send repeated connection requests after no response.

## 4. Using ChatGPT as a Research Assistant

ChatGPT can help structure searches, compare roles, summarize verified public information and suggest which department is most appropriate. It should not be treated as the final source of a phone number, email address or employee role. Verify contact details through the company's official website, company switchboard, LinkedIn or another reliable public professional source before recording them as verified.

Example AI request: "I am trying to reach the correct community-partnership decision-maker at [COMPANY] for a New York statewide youth initiative. Help me create a research plan. I am looking for public professional information only — not private phone numbers, home addresses or personal information. Suggest the likely departments/job titles, Google search queries, official company pages I should check, and what facts I need to verify before outreach. Do not invent a contact."

## 5. Phone Call Protocol

Use the organization's public main business number or publicly listed department number. The purpose of the call is routing — not delivering a five-minute sponsorship pitch to the receptionist.

PHONE SCRIPT "Hi, my name is \_\_\_\_\_. I'm reaching out on behalf of the Student Impact Challenge, a statewide youth initiative in New York. I'm trying to reach the person responsible for community partnerships, corporate social responsibility, charitable giving or community impact. Could you point me to the appropriate person or department?" IF THEY ASK WHAT IT IS: "The initiative engages young people ages 10 to 20 in identifying real problems in their communities and proposing solutions. We're reaching out to organizations about community partnership, awareness and sponsorship opportunities." IF THEY GIVE A NAME: "Thank you. May I confirm their title and the best public business email, extension or department contact for reaching them?" IF THEY CANNOT PROVIDE AN EMAIL: "That's completely fine. Is there a department name, contact form or public webpage you recommend I use?"

## 6. A Name Without an Email Is Still Progress

If the receptionist provides a person's name and title but no email, record it. Then verify the person professionally through LinkedIn and the company website. Search for the organization's published email/contact process. Do not guess an email pattern and mark it as verified unless it has been confirmed through a reliable public business source.

## 7. Google Sheet / Outreach Tracker Fields

| Field                      | What to Record                                       |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Organization               | Official organization name                           |
| Category                   | Bank, law, utility, media, sports, etc.              |
| Priority                   | A / B / C                                            |
| Partnership Type           | Cash / In-kind / Awareness / Mentorship / Experience |
| Original Contact           | Email/contact form/person used first                 |
| Original Email Date        | Date first outreach was sent                         |
| Follow-Up 1                | Date + result                                        |
| Follow-Up 2                | Date + result                                        |
| Main Business Phone        | Public verified company number                       |
| Department Phone/Extension | If publicly provided or given by switchboard         |
| Correct Contact Name       | Verified professional contact                        |
| Title                      | Current verified role                                |
| Business Email             | Public/verified business email                       |
| LinkedIn Profile           | Professional profile URL/reference                   |
| Source                     | Where the contact information was verified           |
| Last Action                | Most recent outreach action                          |
| Next Action                | Call / email / LinkedIn / wait / escalate            |
| Next Follow-Up Date        | Scheduled date                                       |

| Field  | What to Record                                                               |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Status | Researching / Contacted / Replied / Interested / Referred / Nurture / Closed |
| Notes  | Important context, receptionist referral, application instructions, etc.     |

## 8. Recommended 14-Day No-Response Sequence

| Timing                | Action                                                                              |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Day 0                 | Send original personalized email; record it.                                        |
| Day 3–5 business days | Send first short follow-up in the same thread.                                      |
| Day 5–7               | If still silent, research the organization, correct department and current contact. |
| Day 7–9               | Call the public business number to confirm routing/contact information.             |
| Day 8–10              | Send targeted outreach to the newly verified contact or department.                 |
| Day 10–12             | Use one professional LinkedIn touch if appropriate.                                 |
| Day 12–14+            | Final concise follow-up or move to NURTURE. Do not continue contacting repeatedly.  |

## 9. When to Stop Contacting

Stop or pause outreach when the organization says no; asks not to be contacted; provides a formal application process that must be followed; says the timing is wrong and gives a future date; the correct contact has received the approved sequence without response; or program leadership directs the fellow to stop. Record the result so another fellow does not restart the same outreach unnecessarily.

## 10. Privacy & Professional Research Rules

Collect only public professional/business information needed for legitimate program outreach. Do not search for or record private cell numbers, home addresses, personal family information, private email accounts, passwords, private social profiles or other unrelated personal information. If a professional voluntarily provides a direct business number or business email during a call, it may be recorded for the outreach relationship.

## 11. What Counts as Success?

A successful research attempt does not always mean receiving sponsorship. Success can be: identifying the correct department; obtaining a verified contact name; confirming the correct business email; receiving a referral; learning the organization uses an application portal; learning the funding cycle opens later; booking a call; receiving permission to send the sponsorship deck; or receiving a clear no that prevents wasted follow-up.

## 12. Escalate to Program Leadership When

The prospect requests a meeting with leadership; asks for a sponsorship amount or customized package; requests the full sponsorship deck, budget, nonprofit/tax documents or contract; asks about exclusivity/naming rights; expresses financial interest; requests sensitive organizational documents; or the fellow is unsure whether information may be shared.

## Program Contact

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